

Six Popular Open Source Cloud Platforms for the Enterprise



Most of us use cloud services even though we are unaware that we are doing so. Many social media platforms, if not all, are cloud based. A PaaS (Platform-as-a-Service) offering is a third party model in which the service provider offers software and hardware tools, usually for application development. This article discusses a selection of cloud platforms.

In the early days, only geeky end users played around with open source tools and technologies. Today, open source solutions are becoming the *de facto* standard for many large enterprises. Among the many open source tools, the cloud is one of the hot favourites, as it comes with many cost and operational (capex and opex) advantages.

Many cloud based platforms evolved during 2009-2010 and started incorporating many features that were offered 'as a service'. Along with public and private cloud platforms, the hybrid cloud (a combination of the public and private cloud) offering has become popular, as it caters both to the privacy needs (the private cloud) of the organisation as well as the scalability options available when hosting in the public cloud.

In this article, I will discuss six popular cloud based open source platforms and frameworks.

WSO2: A PaaS framework maintained by Apache

In June 2013, WSO2 donated the PaaS framework, Stratos, to Apache. The main intention and goal was to foster a vendor-neutral open cloud community that supports a plethora of cloud environments and protects against cloud lock-in.

From May 2014 onwards, this was heavily supported by

the likes of SUSE, Cisco, Citrix, NASA, Sungard, etc. WSO2 now provides WSO2 Private PaaS 4.0, the first comprehensive, enterprise-grade Platform-as-a-Service based on the Apache Stratos 4.0 PaaS framework, which was released in 2014.

The framework supports the growth of cloud-enabled connected businesses that demand a PaaS capable of handling the disparate applications and tools used by companies, their customers and partners. The announcement was made in conjunction with WSO2Con Europe 2014.

WSO2 in a nutshell: This is a Platform-as-a-Service (PaaS) framework from the Apache free source community.

It provides:

- The Elastic Scalability feature for any type of service, using the underlying infra cloud
- Managing, logging and metering of supported services
- Foundation services for:
 - User management
 - Storage and billing

WSO2 architecture explained: WSO2 or Stratos architecture has multiple components to it. As mentioned earlier, along with logging and metering, it has many services components that contain load balancers (which are nothing but service nodes).